



ON THE HIGH SEAS

Rimsky-Korsakov's (front row, right) three-year voyage on the clipper *Almaz* confirmed in him a love of the sea, which he expressed in many of his operas and symphonic works.

Russian-flavored music

Rimsky-Korsakov's light onshore duties left ample time for composition. His *Fantasia on Serbian Themes*, first heard at the Moscow Slavonic Conference in 1867, reflected its composer's solidarity with Slavs in Russia and beyond. The critic Vladimir Stasov responded with affection by dubbing Rimsky-Korsakov and his fellow nationalist composers—namely Balakirev, Alexander Borodin, Modest Mussorgsky, and César Cui—as *Moguchaya kuchka*, or the Mighty Handful, a group that was often known outside Russia as *The Five*.

While completing his first opera, *The Maid of Pskov*, Rimsky-Korsakov became a professor of composition at the St. Petersburg Conservatory. He remained on the staff until his death